

ACTIVITY 11 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**Affinity Diagram and Kano Analysis**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE
Elective Activity	45 min	DEFINE

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Two Define-phase tools from the original course. Use an Affinity Diagram to cluster unstructured VOC input into themes, then apply Kano Analysis to classify requirements as Must-Be, One-Dimensional or Delighter.

What you will produce: An Affinity Diagram of named VOC clusters and a Kano classification table identifying where to invest first.

Tools and techniques: Affinity Diagram, Kano Analysis, VOC clustering

The scenario

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder**data/ — the mock data you analyse:**

- voice-of-customer.csv — 10 rows (id, customer_statement, source, date)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- affinity-groups.csv (voc_id, statement, affinity_group)
- kano-classification.csv (requirement, kano_class_MustBe_OneDim_Delighter, why, invest_first)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

Your steps

1. Write each VOC statement on a separate note — one idea per note.
2. Cluster related notes into natural groups without talking, then name each group.
3. Classify each requirement as Must-Be, One-Dimensional or Delighter.
4. Plot the requirements on the Kano diagram and identify where to invest first.

Your working space

Complete every field. Keep this worksheet — it is your reference for applying the method at work.

Step 1 — Write each VOC statement on a separate note — one idea per note.

Step 2 — Cluster related notes into natural groups without talking, then name each group.

Step 3 — Classify each requirement as Must-Be, One-Dimensional or Delighter.

Step 4 — Plot the requirements on the Kano diagram and identify where to invest first.

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Which requirement is a Must-Be that nobody would ever praise you for meeting?

2. Where would investment produce the most satisfaction per unit of effort?

3. Did silent clustering change the grouping versus discussing it?

Reflect & discuss

What Delighter could you add to your own service at almost no cost?

Which Must-Be is your team currently failing?

Check your work

Every VOC note sits in exactly one named affinity group and carries a Kano classification.